Modern History Topic 01 - ASCII Master Flow Diagram

Decline of the Mughal Empire (1707-1740s)

ASCII MASTER FLOW — PANEL 1/16: Scope: decline of command, not disappearance
1707 -> imperial command weakens; dynasty, titles and Persianate grammar endure
CORE WINDOW -> succession, factions, jagirs, regions and Nadir Shah to the 1740s
NOT THE CLAIM -> instant 1707 collapse, universal Indian decline or Company inevitability
ANSWER RULE -> distinguish enforceable authority from symbolic legitimacy.
MUST REMEMBER: Aurangzeb's death in 1707 begins the core sequence; succession wars, factional competition, jagirdari-fiscal stress, regional assertion and Nadir Shah's 1739 invasion interacted.

ASCII MASTER FLOW — PANEL 2/16: Chronology from Aurangzeb to the 1740s
1707 Aurangzeb dies -> Bahadur Shah I 1707-12 -> Jahandar Shah 1712-13
1713 Farrukhsiyar rises with Sayyid support -> 1719 deposition and enthronements
1720 Sayyids fall -> 1724 Nizam's Hyderabad autonomy -> 1739 Karnal and Delhi
1740s -> regional bargaining and frontier pressure; later Durrani/Panipat stay bounded.

ASCII MASTER FLOW — PANEL 3/16: Bahadur Shah I, 1707-1712: partial conciliation, not a settlement
JAJAU 1707 -> defeats Azam | DECCAN 1709 -> defeats Kam Bakhsh
POLICY -> conciliation with Rajputs, Marathas and Sikhs, not confrontation
MARATHAS -> sardeshmukhi conceded; chauth and the Shahu-Tarabai succession left unresolved
RESULT -> temporary calm bought at rising fiscal cost; no durable settlement reached.

ASCII MASTER FLOW — PANEL 4/16: Succession instability: throne becomes a prize
NO FIXED PRIMOGENITURE -> princes mobilise households and noble clients
SUCCESSION WAR -> victory reallocates mansab, jagir and office
REPEATED CONTEST -> emperor cannot credibly arbitrate elite competition
RESULT -> political transmission fails; it is a mechanism, not a lone cause.

ASCII MASTER FLOW — PANEL 5/16: Factions, the Sayyid moment and the 1717 farman
TURANI / IRANI / AFGHAN / HINDUSTANI -> shifting patronage formations
FARRUKHSIYAR 1713 -> Sayyid Brothers supply military-political support
1717 FARMAN -> Farrukhsiyar grants the English Company duty-free trade in Bengal (a commercial privilege, not a grant of territory or sovereignty)
1719 -> kingmaking exposes the throne's dependence on coalition control
1720 -> Sayyids removed; factional politics survives the two individuals.

ASCII MASTER FLOW — PANEL 6/16: Jagirdari vocabulary prevents category errors
JAGIR -> transferable revenue assignment, not private landownership
JAMA -> assessed claim | HASIL -> realised collection
PAIBAQI -> reserve assignable pool | BE-JAGIRI -> usable jagir shortage
TRAP -> nominal assessment never automatically measures treasury cash or welfare.

ASCII MASTER FLOW — PANEL 7/16: Fiscal-military feedback loop
MORE CLAIMANTS + WEAK PAIBAQI -> scramble for productive jagirs
SHORT TENURE / EXTRACTION -> resistance, evasion, flight or negotiation
LOWER HASIL -> unpaid contingents and weaker imperial service
WEAKER CONTROL -> regional retention of revenue -> still lower central capacity.

ASCII MASTER FLOW — PANEL 8/16: Aurangzeb's legacy: a weighted background
DECCAN WAR -> garrisons, transport, remounts and unresolved Maratha challenge

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ANNEXATIONS -> territory and claims grow faster than reliable realisation
NORTH ABSENCE -> strains of supervision and arbitration
QUALIFY -> legacy mattered, but Aurangzeb alone cannot explain post-1707 factions or regions.

ASCII MASTER FLOW — PANEL 9/16: Agrarian and regional assertion
REVENUE PRESSURE -> zamindars, peasants and intermediaries bargain or resist
GOVERNORS + BANKERS + ARMED FOLLOWINGS -> provincial resource control
MARATHA / SIKH / JAT mobilisation -> distinct political routes, not one rebellion
RESULT -> Delhi's weakening and regional state-making reinforce each other.

ASCII MASTER FLOW — PANEL 10/16: Chauth and sardeshmukhi: Maratha claims turn into imperial bargains
CHAUTH -> approximately one-quarter revenue claim over designated territory
SARDESHMUKHI -> additional roughly ten-per-cent superior-chieftainship claim
1718-19 SETTLEMENT -> Sayyid-brokered recognition of Shahu's claims for Maratha support
FROM 1720 -> Baji Rao converts settled claims into offensive reach across Malwa/Gujarat.

ASCII MASTER FLOW — PANEL 11/16: Successor-state spectrum
BENGAL 1717 -> Murshid Quli Khan | AWADH 1722 -> Saadat Khan | HYDERABAD 1724 -> Nizam-ul-Mulk
IMPERIAL OFFICE -> local revenue, army and patronage become durable
COIN / KHUTBA / TITLE -> formal Mughal legitimacy may remain useful
TRAP -> autonomy in substance does not require a modern declaration of independence.

ASCII MASTER FLOW — PANEL 12/16: Muhammad Shah, 1719-1748: long reign, shrinking centre
1719 -> enthroned after the Sayyid-controlled succession crisis; 1720 -> Sayyids overthrown
1724 -> Nizam-ul-Mulk himself quits the imperial wizarat and founds Hyderabad
COURT CULTURE -> Delhi's music, poetry and painting flourish under the 'Rangila' patron-emperor
TRAP -> 'Rangila' names a cultural sobriquet, not a structural cause; do not use it as an answer.

ASCII MASTER FLOW — PANEL 13/16: Nadir Shah: shock exposes a prior crisis
FRONTIER WEAKNESS + Persian military capacity -> invasion opportunity
KARNAL, 24 FEBRUARY 1739 -> fragmented command loses to unified command
DELHI -> massacre and plunder; PEACOCK THRONE and KOH-I-NOOR carried off
OUTCOME -> Muhammad Shah remains emperor; territories west of the Indus ceded
VERDICT -> accelerant and revealer, not the original cause of decline.
CLOSE DISTINCTION: decline of enforceable central command did not mean instant state collapse, civilisational decline or disappearance of Mughal titles, revenue forms and Persianate legitimacy.

ASCII MASTER FLOW — PANEL 14/16: Bounded post-1740 frontier: Abdali and Panipat stay outside the core
1747 -> Nadir Shah assassinated; Ahmad Shah Abdali (Durrani) rises in Afghanistan
1748 -> Abdali's first invasion checked near Sirhind; Muhammad Shah dies the same year
1748-1761 -> repeated Durrani invasions exploit the frontier opened in 1739
1761 -> Third Battle of Panipat (Maratha-Durrani contest)
BOUNDARY -> this sequence is a consequence/bridge only; its causes and course belong to Medieval History Topic 25 and Modern History Topic 02, not to this core 1707-1740s answer.

ASCII MASTER FLOW — PANEL 15/16: Institutional continuity after contraction
EMPEROR / FARMAN / SANAD -> symbolic arbitration and legal vocabulary
COIN + KHUTBA -> layered legitimacy | PERSIAN CHANCERY -> portable administration

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MANSAB / DIWAN / ZAMINDAR -> institutions repurposed in regional arenas

RULE -> continuity of form coexists with change in who commands resources.

EVIDENCE LIMIT: Satish Chandra's jagirdari analysis, regional-state evidence and court chronicles must be compared; no single-ruler or British-inevitability thesis is sufficient.

ASCII MASTER FLOW — PANEL 16/16: Source limits, PYQ ownership and Topic 01 answer spine

SOURCE LIMIT -> no fixed casualty figure for the 1739 Delhi massacre; no invented official key

PYQ OWNERSHIP -> zero direct routed CSE question for Topic 01 across 2018-2026

2021 Prelims Q48 (successor states) -> owned by Modern History Topic 02

2021 Prelims Q45 (pargana-sarkar-subah) -> owned by Medieval History Topic 16

2022 GS-I Mains Q2 (Company armies) -> owned by Modern History Topic 05

OPEN -> central fiscal-military command declined inside a continuing political culture

EXPLAIN -> succession + faction + jagir-agrarian strain + regional assertion

WEIGH -> Deccan legacy matters; reject Aurangzeb-only monocausality

TEST -> Nadir 1739 exposes weakness; continuity and regional variation qualify conclusion

CLOSE -> stop core chronology in the 1740s.